

MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

SEMESTER 1

DMBA114

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION



Unit – 1

Basic Principles of Communication

TABLE OF CONTENTS

SL No	Topic	Fig No / Table / Graph	SAQ / Activity	Page No
1	Introduction	-	-	4
1.1	Objectives	-	-	
2	Understanding Communication	-	1	5 - 6
3	Communication Process	1	2,1	7 - 9
4	Barriers to Communication	-	3	10 - 16
4.1	Noise	-	-	
4.2	Barriers to Communication	2	-	
4.3	Overcoming The Barriers to Communication	-	-	
	4.3.1 Organizational Action	-	-	
	4.3.2 Individual Action	-	-	
5	Classification of Communication	-	4	17 - 19
6	Importance of Communication in The Workplace	-	5	20 - 21
7	Summary	-	-	22 - 23
8	Glossary	-	-	24
9	Terminal Questions	-	-	25
10	Answers	-	-	26 - 27
10.1	Self-Assessment Questions	-	-	
10.2	Terminal Questions	-	-	
11	Case Study	-	-	28 - 29
12	References	-	-	30

1. INTRODUCTION

Communication is an important component of success in our personal and professional lives. It is the key to build favourable relationships. It is a part of 'soft skills' as opposed to the domain or technical knowledge, which comes under 'hard skills.' A formal study of business communication is important since the average business executive today spends a good part of his time on the job communicating in some form or the other. In this unit, we will discuss how communication involves certain key elements, no matter in what context it takes place. We will also examine some of the general problems that come in the way of smooth communication and ways of overcoming these problems.

So, the unit will provide answers to questions such as:

1. What is the meaning of communication?
2. What are the elements involved in communication?
3. How can we overcome the barriers to communication?
4. What are the different categories of communication?
5. Why is communication important in an organisation?

1.1. Objectives

After studying this unit, you should be able to:

- Define the characteristics of communication
- Explain the key elements in the communication process
- Identify the barriers to communication and suggest ways to overcome those barriers
- Examine how good communication contributes to overall managerial success



2. UNDERSTANDING COMMUNICATION

Communication in simple terms is a transfer of information between people, resulting in a common understanding between them.

Communication has been defined differently by different writers and behavioural theorists.

Some popular definitions are as follows:

- According to Newman and Summer, “Communication is an exchange of facts, ideas, opinions or emotions by two or more persons”.
- According to Allen Louis, “It is the sum of all the things one person does when he wants to create an understanding in the mind of another”.
- Bellows, Gilson, and Odiorne define communication as “A communion by words, letters, symbols or messages, and as a way that one organisation member shares meaning with the other”.
- Hoben defines communication as “The verbal interchange of thoughts or ideas”.
- In the words of Anderson, “Communication is the process by which we understand others and in turn, endeavor to be understood by them. It is dynamic, constantly changing and shifting in response to the total situation”.
- According to Berelson and Steiner, “Communication is the transmission of information, ideas, emotions, skills, etc. by the use of symbols, words, pictures, figures, graphs, etc.”
- In the words of Fotheringham, “Communication is a process involving the selection, production, and transmission of signs in such a way as to help a receiver perceive a meaning similar to that in the mind of the communicator”.

From all these definitions, it is clear that communication has the following characteristics:

- ***It is unavoidable*** – It is impossible not to communicate, since we communicate unintentionally all the time, even without the use of words. Our body language, the way we dress, the importance we give to arriving on time, our behaviour, and the physical environment in which we work, all convey certain messages to others.
- ***It is a two-way exchange of information*** – Communication is sharing of information between two or more persons, with continuous feedback.
- ***It is a process*** – Each message is part of a process and does not occur in isolation. This means that the meaning attached to a message depends on what has happened before and in the

present context. For example, your boss' response to your promotion request will depend on your past relationship with him and his mood at that moment.

- ***It involves a sender and a receiver of information*** – Any communication starts with a sender of a message and requires a receiver to attach some meaning to that message.
- ***It could be verbal or non-verbal*** – Communication could be through the use of words in spoken or written form, or through the use of body language such as gestures and facial expressions.
- ***It is successful when the receiver interprets the meaning in the same way as intended by the sender*** – The receiver may not always attach the same meaning to a message as the sender. When the message is wrongly interpreted, the communication is a failure.
- ***It is a dynamic process*** – Communication involves sharing thoughts and experiences in a meaningful manner while assimilating, processing, and responding to the person one is talking with. The mode and manner of communication may vary according to the situation.
- ***It enables understanding*** – Communication enables people to understand the necessity for change, the reasons for performing certain things, the method of implementing processes, and the importance of their actions.

SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS – 1

Fill in the blanks:	
1	Communication is sharing of information between two or more people, with continuous_____.
2	The receiver may not always attach the same meaning to a message as the_____.
True or False:	
3	Communication can occur in isolation. (True/False)

3. COMMUNICATION PROCESS

Let us now look at communication as a process and discuss its key elements.

Irrespective of the setting in which communication takes place or the number of people that are involved, all communication consists of certain key elements. The communication model shown in figure 1 illustrates each of these elements.

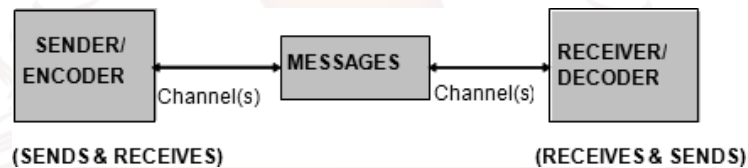


Figure 1: Communication Model

The elements involved in communication are:

- **Sender or encoder** – This is the person who transmits a message. For example, a manager writing a letter to a consultant after a meeting or a sales manager making a presentation to the sales team. Here the manager is the sender.
- **Receiver or decoder** – The person who notices and decodes or attaches some meaning to a message. Decoding may not always be accurate, and a message may impart a wrong meaning. For example, a friendly joke might be taken as an offence, or feedback given to a subordinate by a superior might be taken in the wrong sense.
- **Message** – This is any signal that triggers the response of a receiver. Messages may be intentional (as in the example of the sales presentation by a manager to the sales team) or unintentional (non-verbal signals such as yawns that convey the message of boredom).
- **Channel** – This refers to the medium or the method used to deliver the message. As a business executive, you will often have a choice of channels. For example, you could communicate with a customer through a letter, email or telephone.
- **Feedback** – Most communication is two-way. Receivers generally respond to messages. For example, students may ask questions during a lecture session and an employer may tell an employee that he has to think about his proposal. This response to a sender's message is called feedback. This kind of feedback is oral. Sometimes feedback can also be given in a written form. For example, a manager can send a written response to a customer's letter of complaint. At other times, feedback could be non-verbal, as in smiles and nods of appreciation during a talk or presentation. Even failure to respond could be considered as feedback, since it may indicate a

lack of interest or indifference to the sender's message. Due to the element of feedback, people are simultaneously senders and receivers of information in face-to-face communication.

- **Context** – This refers to the setting in which the communication takes place and could sometimes determine the success or failure of the communication. Context can be classified as follows:
 - **Physical context** – This refers to the physical surroundings. For example, a work or social environment, in which communication takes place. Asking your boss for a promotion might be received differently, depending on whether the communication takes place in your office, your boss' office, at a company party, or over lunch at a restaurant.
 - **Social context** – This refers to the relationship between the sender and the receiver. Taking the same example, asking for a promotion is likely to be received differently, depending on how well you get along with your boss and whether you are personal friends or not.
 - **Chronological context** – This refers to time-related factors that could influence communication. For example, is your request made first thing in the morning or at the far end of the day? Is it made during or after work hours? Is it done at a time when the company is going through problems such as a strike in the factory, or major losses?
 - **Cultural context** – This refers to the similarity of backgrounds between the sender and the receiver, such as age, language, nationality, religion and gender. These factors could influence communication favourably or unfavourably.

Each of these key elements contributes to the success of communication. In other words, communication can go wrong if any of the following elements go wrong:

- The wrong person sends the message. For example, a junior accountant in a company writing a letter to a bank, asking for a loan for a project worth several crore, is not likely to get the bank's approval.
- The message is unclear or contains grammatical mistakes and / or inappropriate words. There may also be too much information conveyed in the message, leading to confusion and information overload.
- The wrong channel of communication is chosen. Placing an ad for a liquor product in a religious magazine for example, is not likely to be received favourably.
- The message is wrongly interpreted, i.e., the receiver attaches the wrong meaning to the message.
- The feedback is not adequate to ensure understanding.

- Physical, physiological or psychological noise distorts the message.
- The communication takes place in the wrong physical, social, chronological, or cultural context.

This brings us to the next topic, namely the barriers or obstacles to effective communication.

Activity - 1

Select any situation at your home, workplace or college in which you were involved. Prepare a brief summary of the communication process, using the various elements of communication discussed in this unit.

(Refer section 1.3 for detailed guidelines.)



4. BARRIERS TO COMMUNICATION

Communication fails when the message received is not identical to the message that is sent. Several factors could interfere with the exchange of messages.

4.1. Noise

‘Noise’ refers to all these factors that disrupt communication and can be classified under the following types:

- **Physical noise** – Distracting sounds, poor acoustics, or just information overload could interfere with the listening process.
- **Physiological noise** – Hearing or other disabilities, fatigue, or physical illness could come in the way of both speaking and listening.
- **Psychological noise** – Sometimes emotions within the sender or receiver such as preoccupations, hostility, fear or lack of interest could interfere with the speaking or listening process.

4.2. Barriers to Communication

There are many other barriers to communication, an understanding and analysis of which are needed before coming up with ways to eliminate or minimize them.

Figure 1.2 depicts the barriers to communication.

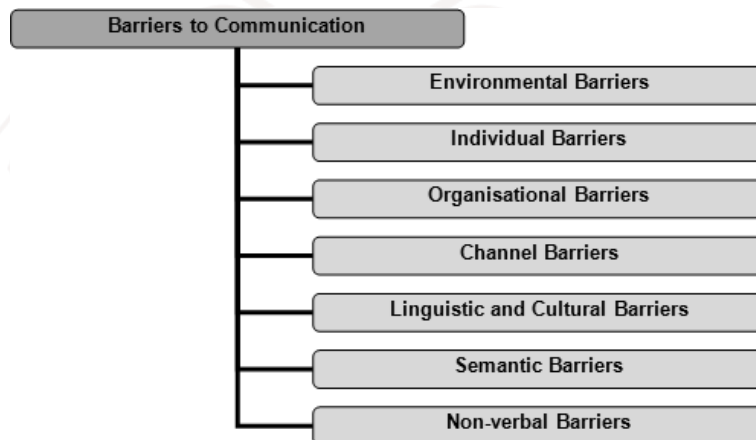


Figure 2: Barriers to Communication

As shown in figure 1.2, the barriers to communication may be classified as follows:

- **Environmental barriers** – An environmental barrier is the same as physical noise, which could be in the form of distracting sounds, an overcrowded room, poor facilities and acoustics, all of which may hinder the ability to listen to and understand the message.
- **Individual barriers** – A major barrier to interpersonal communication is a tendency to judge, evaluate, approve, or disapprove of the views of another person. This happens particularly in situations where we have strong feelings about something. In such cases, we tend to block out communication and form our own viewpoints.
- **Organisational barriers** – In organisations that are too hierarchical, that is, where there are multiple 'layers', messages may have to pass through many levels before they finally reach the receiver. Each level may add to, modify or completely change the message, so much so that it becomes distorted by the time it reaches the intended receiver. In other words, there is likely to be a loss of meaning and the message may not reach the receiver in the same way as it was intended by the sender.

The following example illustrates an organisational barrier to communication. By the time the message is passed down from the Chief to the lower-level executives, it is distorted completely, to the extent that the original message is interpreted differently by each level in the organisation.

The Chief of the Space Centre gets to know about the possibility of seeing Halley's Comet and decides that the entire organisation should witness this spectacle. He sends the following memo to the Director.

Tomorrow evening, at 20:00 hours, we will be able to see Halley's Comet in the sky through the naked eye. Since this is not an everyday event, everyone at the Centre should assemble outside in their best clothes to watch it. If it rains, we will not be able to see it very well, in which case everyone should assemble in the Canteen.

To Director

Chief, Space Centre

The Director then sends the following memo to various Executive Directors:

By order of the Chief, we will be able to see 'Halley's Comet' at 20:00 hrs, tomorrow evening. If it is raining, we shall not be able to see it very well on site, in our best clothes. In that case, the disappearance of the Comet will be followed through in the Canteen. This is something which we cannot see happening every day.

To Director

Executive Directors

The Executive Director sends out memos to the Heads of Departments as follows:

By order of the Chief, we shall follow through, in our best clothes, the disappearance of the Comet in the Canteen at 20:00 hrs, tomorrow evening. The Chief will tell us whether it is going to rain. This is something which we cannot see happening every day.

To Executive Director

Heads of Departments

The Heads of Departments send the following message to their managers:

If it is raining in the Canteen tomorrow evening, which is something we cannot see happening every day, our Chief in his best clothes will disappear at 20:00 hrs.

To Head of Department

All Managers

Finally, each Manager sends the following notice to their Executives

Tomorrow evening, at 20:00 hrs. our Chief will disappear. It is a pity that we cannot see this happening every day.

Another type of organisational barrier is a 'departmental barrier'. This means that each department in an organisation function in isolation and there is no coordination or communication between them.

- **Channel barriers** – In the earlier section, it was pointed out that communication can fail due to any of the different elements going wrong. The wrong choice of channel is one of the main barriers to communication. Using the wrong medium of advertising, or conveying a message orally when a written letter would be more appropriate, are examples. The written channel is

more appropriate when the communication is more formal or for keeping things on record, while emotional messages such as feelings about co-workers are better conveyed orally.

- **Linguistic and cultural barriers** – When the sender of the message uses a language that the receiver does not understand, the communication will not succeed. Either the sender may be using a different or foreign language, or the language used may be too highly technical for the receiver to understand

Linguistic barriers may also occur in cross-cultural advertising and distort communication when translating campaigns or slogans literally from one language to another. For example, Pepsi's slogan "Come Alive with Pepsi", when translated into Chinese, reads "Pepsi brings your ancestors back from the grave!". There are also instances of accidents that have happened in the air because the pilot of a different origin failed to follow the directions given by the Air Traffic Controller who spoke with a different accent.

Cultural differences refer to differences in values and perceptions, which may affect the interpretation of the message by the receiver. For example, a joke about women may be taken in the wrong sense if the receiver belongs to a culture in which women are highly respected.

- **Semantic barriers** – The word 'semantics' refers to the meaning of words and the way in which they are used. For example, different words may have different meanings in different cultures. Failure to take this into consideration could lead to serious blunders.

Example – Saying 'The new product launch went like a bomb' in British English would mean that the new product launch was a success.

On the other hand, saying 'The product launch bombed' in American English would mean that the new product was a disaster.

- **Non-verbal barriers** – This refers to the non-verbal communication that goes with a particular message. Non-verbal communication includes tone of voice, body language such as gestures and facial expressions, etc. If the tone of voice and body language is negative, the communication will fail, however positive the spoken and written message.

For example, if you happen to meet a long-lost friend and say "I am delighted to meet you", but in a sad tone of voice, the exact opposite message will be conveyed!

Therefore, it is important to avoid giving conflicting signals, through the use of non-verbal communication.

SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS – 2

True or False:	
4	Encoder is the person who transmits a message. (True/False)
5	A channel is any signal that triggers the response of a receiver. (True/False)
6	You feel that your professor does not have anything new to say and you do not listen to him. This is an example of physiological noise leading to communication failure. (True/False)
7	Your boss gives you a good performance review at a time when the company is making profits. This is an example of chronological context influencing communication. (True/False)
Choose the correct answer:	
8	Which of the following is a psychological noise? a) Lack of interest b) Poor acoustics c) Information overload d) Fatigue

4.3. Overcoming the Barriers to Communication

Certain steps can be taken, both at the organisational level, as well as at the individual level, to effectively deal with the barriers to communication, to try to minimise them, if not eliminate them entirely.

4.3.1. Organisational Action

Employees of an organisation accomplish workplace communication through several communication channels. One of the commonly cited problems in organisations is poor workplace communication. Hence organisations need to take a few steps to ensure effective communication. Some of the steps which an organisation can take to overcome the barriers to effective communication are as follows:

- **Encourage feedback** – Organisations should try to improve the communication system by getting feedback on the messages already sent. Feedback can tell the managers whether the message has reached the receiver in an intended way or not.
- **Create a climate of openness** – A climate of trust and openness can go a long way in removing organisational barriers to communication. All subordinates or junior employees should be allowed to air their opinions and differences without fear of being penalised.

- **Use multiple channels of communication** – Organisations should encourage the use of multiple channels of communication, in order to make sure that messages reach the intended receivers without fail. This means using a combination of both oral and written channels, as well as formal (official) and informal (unofficial) channels of communication.

4.3.2. Individual Action

An individual can take certain actions to overcome the communication barriers. These actions will help to improve interpersonal relationships with others both in one's personal and business life. Some of the actions that an individual can take are:

- **Active listening** – This means listening to the meaning of the speaker's words, rather than listening without hearing, or 'passive listening'. Passive listening is a barrier to communication, whereas real communication takes place when we listen actively, with understanding. Listening is a skill that can be developed through proper training.
- **Careful choice of words** – The words of the message should bear clarity so that the received message carries the same meaning as the sent message.
- **Selection of appropriate channels** – Individuals should be competent enough to choose the right communication channel, depending on the situation.
- **Avoidance of technical language** – The language used in communication must be as clear as possible. Usage of unnecessary technical terms can lead to misunderstandings. Hence, an individual has to use technical words only when necessary.
- **Right feedback** – Feedback is an important communication skill. The correct feedback can elicit the correct action. The feedback given must be a proper combination of criticism and information sharing.

SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS – 3

Match the Following:

- | | |
|----|--|
| 11 | Match the following:

Set A

A. Overcrowded room
B. Words with different meanings in different cultures
C. Tone of voice
D. Wrong medium of advertising |
|----|--|

	Set B 1. Non-verbal barrier 2. Channel barrier 3. Environmental barrier 4. Semantic barrier
Fill in the Blanks:	
12	The barrier that may also occur in cross-cultural advertising and distorted communication is _____.
13	The _____ means listening to the meaning of the speaker's words, rather than listening without hearing.



5. CLASSIFICATION OF COMMUNICATION

Experts categorise communication into different types based on the following factors:

- Number of people involved in communication
- Physical proximity of the communicators
- Immediacy of communication
- The context of communication

The various types of communication are:

- Interpersonal communication
- Intrapersonal communication
- Group communication
- Mass communication

Let us now discuss the features of these classes of communication.

Interpersonal communication

Interpersonal communication usually involves direct face-to-face contact between the sender and the receiver. It can be both in a verbal and non-verbal form. Feedback is an important concept of interpersonal communication. We can classify interpersonal communication, based on the number of people involved, as:

- ***Dyadic communication*** – This involves two people.
- ***Group communication*** – This involves three or more people. Communication usually takes place for problem-solving or decision-making.
- ***Public communication*** – This involves a large number of people. Communication usually takes place for information sharing and persuasion.

Mediated interpersonal communication makes use of technology for sending and receiving messages. For example, two business colleagues communicate using a telephone or e-mail. By using mediated communication, we can communicate over large distances or for different periods. Mediated communication can be formal or informal in nature.

Intrapersonal communication

Intrapersonal communication is self-communication. This is the most basic form of communication. It occurs for clarifying ideas or for analysing a situation. It involves the following activities:

- **Internal discourse** – This involves analysis, concentration and contemplation.
- **Vocal communication** – This involves talking aloud to oneself and is done for clarifying or rehearsing messages.
- **Written communication** – This involves making entries in journals or diaries.

We can thus use intrapersonal communication to process data, encode data before sending a message, and decode data when we receive messages.

Group communication

Group communication usually takes place between three to twenty individuals. The basic resource of any group is its members. Hence, communication is very important for a group to achieve its goals. Group communication can be achieved in any of the following forms:

- Verbal
- Non-verbal
- Written
- Electronic

The factors that affect group communication are:

- The nature of the task
- The personalities and abilities of the group members
- Environmental factors

Communication is essential for creating and sustaining groups. Generally, groups need a facilitator to ensure that the group achieves its goals. The facilitator establishes rules and guidelines for communication within the group. Facilitators can provide feedback to the group members and make suggestions to find remedy for the problems in group communication.

The advances in electronic and digital technology have influenced the way in which groups function in contemporary organisations. The group communication processes result in a group outcome like a decision or a plan.

Mass communication

Mass communication is communication that employs some form of media like the television, radio or the Internet to communicate to a very large audience.

The characteristics that distinguish mass communication are:

- **Source** – The source is generally a person or a group (like a news editor or a reporter) operating in an organisational setting. The message communicated is the result of the work of many people (such as writers, directors, editors, graphic designers).
- **Message** – The messages conveyed are complex and elaborate. For example, a magazine article, a television program, or a billboard advertisement.
- **Channel** – The channel employed involves more than one technology. For example, the radio makes use of microphones, transmitters, tape machines, and receivers.
- **Audience** – The audience is self-elected people who tune in to the radio program or read a magazine. Mass audiences are from diverse backgrounds and have dissimilar socio-political characteristics. They are spread over a large geographical area.
- **Feedback** – As the message flow is usually one-way, the feedback is minimal and delayed.
- **Noise** – The noise can be caused due to semantic, mechanical, or environmental reasons.

Businesses employ mass communication to send out company-wide messages to other companies or the general public. Memos and e-mails are used to send company-wide mass messages. Mass communication messages are sent to other companies to persuade them to use the company's products or services. Mass communication messages are sent to the public to inform them of the company's policies or goals and for marketing purposes.

SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS – 4

Fill in the blanks:	
12	_____ is an important concept of interpersonal communication.
Choose the correct answer:	
13	Group communication usually takes place between twenty to thirty individuals. (True/False)
14	As the message flow is usually one-way in mass communication, the feedback is minimal and delayed. (True/False)

6. IMPORTANCE OF COMMUNICATION IN THE WORKPLACE

Communication is the nerve centre of business today. As you go up the corporate ladder, you will find that communication skills are required, more than technical skills. Communication research has revealed that among the factors most important for managerial success, communication skills rank above technical skills. According to a survey conducted by National Commission on Writing, American businesses spend \$3.1 billion (about \$10 per person in the US) per year to provide training on remedial writing. Several surveys conducted among people who have been successful in their professions have indicated that communication skills are more vital to job success than subjects taken in college.

Communication is also required in this age of information technology. Without communication and human skills, technology will overwhelm an organisation. Communication helps to make sense of technology and manage all this information. For example, communication is required to explain a new computer program or software. While computers can perform routine tasks, jobs like responding to customers' needs require a high degree of communication skills.

Effective communication serves the following specific purposes in an organisation:

- ***Greater awareness of organisational goals and teamwork*** – When there is open communication between superiors, co-workers, and subordinates, there is a smooth flow of information regarding the goals of the organisation. Coordination between the different departments, in particular, leads to greater motivation to work together towards achieving a common organisational goal, rather than working in isolation.
- ***Better employer-employee relationships*** – By listening to employees, showing empathy, and giving them the freedom to express their opinions without fear of being repressed, a manager can create a climate of openness that leads to better work relationships. Employees will then feel more comfortable approaching their superiors and discussing any matter with them.
- ***Problem-solving*** – Effective communication can help resolve conflicts between co-workers, and work-related and performance-related problems. Face-to-face communication is especially suited for achieving this task since it is one-to-one and highly personalised in nature.
- ***Improved performance*** – Effective communication by managers at the time of appraising the performance of their employees can point out areas for improvement. A constructive review of

performance, through which a manager gives positive feedback and counsels the employee, instead of criticising him for poor performance, can motivate the employee to perform better.

- **Stronger link between managers and the external environment** – Apart from internal communication within the organisation, effective communication by managers with external audiences such as customers, government, bankers, media and suppliers leads to a better rapport with them. A manager will understand the needs of his customers and be aware of quality suppliers of material, government regulations, and the expectations of the community at large, only through proper communication.

Communication has assumed even greater importance today since the new model of business is based on teamwork, rather than on individual action. Teamwork requires greater coordination and communication.

Common mistakes made in communication:

- Spelling
- Punctuation
- Grammar

For example, if Meena sends the following e-mail to Sheela:

Thanks Sheela, I have received your **massage**. Let us have the meeting next **weak**.

Sheela, on receiving the message, is likely to have a wrong impression about Meena. Hence it is always better to check the spelling, grammar and punctuation in a message.

SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS – 5

Fill in the blanks:	
15	Communication has assumed even greater importance today, since the new model of business is based on _____, rather than on action.
16	The _____ communication is especially suitable for resolving conflicts between co-workers, work related and performance related problems.
True or False:	
17	Effective communication by managers during the employee appraisal period can point out areas for improvement. (True/False)

7. SUMMARY

Let us recapitulate the important concepts discussed in this unit:

- Although there is no single and correct definition of communication, most communication theorists and writers on the subject agree that communication has the following characteristics:
 - It is a non-stop process like breathing since we communicate all the time in some form or another.
 - Communication is not only through the spoken and written word. A large part of it is also non-verbal.
 - Communication usually involves a two-way exchange of information, where the receiver provides some feedback in some form or the other.
 - Communication may be said to be accurate when the intended message is understood in the same way by the receiver.
- Irrespective of the number of people involved, communication always includes the following key elements:
 - A sender who transmits a message
 - A receiver who decodes or attaches meaning to a message
 - A channel or medium through which the message is sent
 - Feedback given by the receiver to the sender
 - Noise that can disrupt communication at any time
 - The context in which the communication takes place
- Communication is not always successful and can go wrong if any of the key elements go wrong.
- There are several barriers to smooth communication. These may be categorised as follows:
 - External or physical barriers
 - Individual barriers
 - Organisational barriers
 - Linguistic or cultural barriers
 - Semantic barriers
 - Channel barriers
 - Non-verbal barriers
- The various types of communication are:

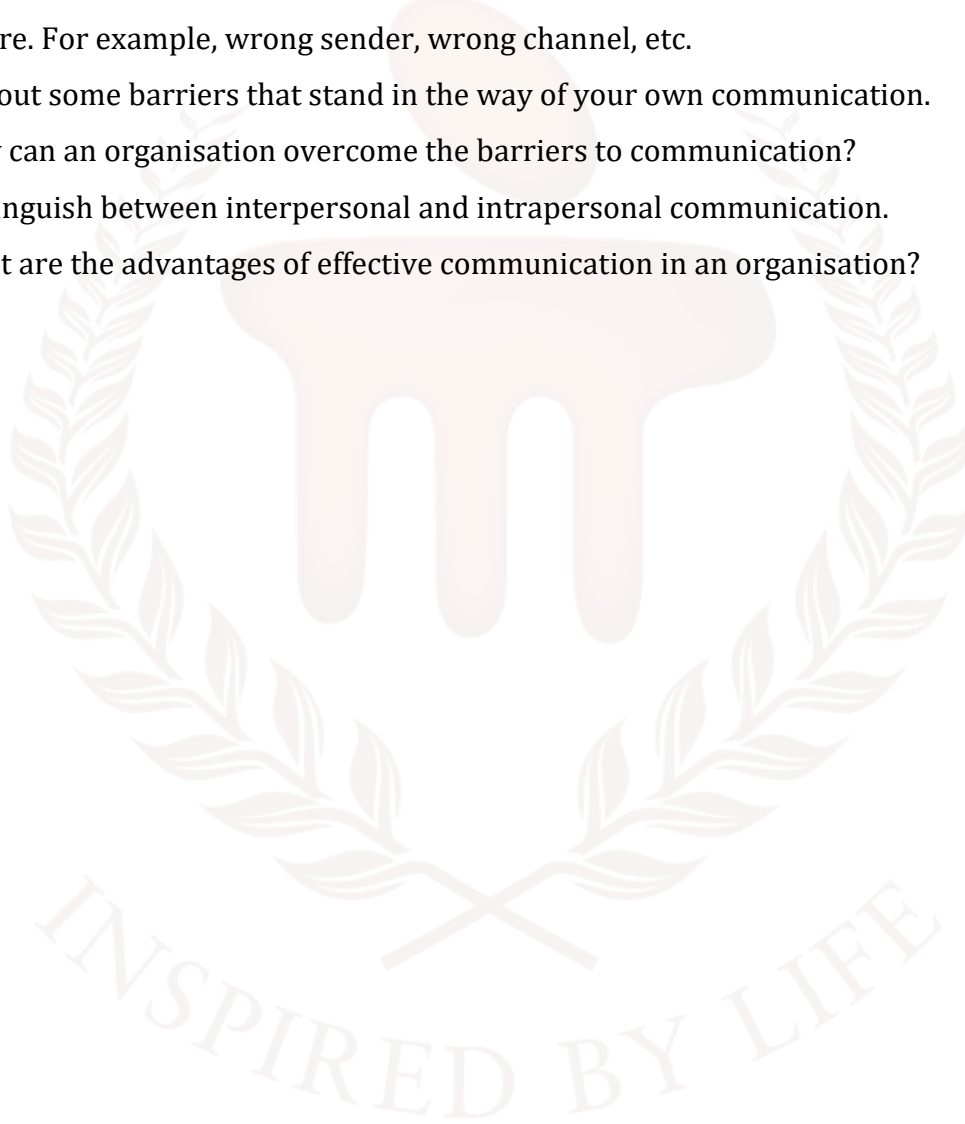
- Interpersonal communication – Interpersonal communication usually involves direct face-to-face contact between the sender and the receiver.
- Intrapersonal communication – Intrapersonal communication is self- communication.
- Group communication – Group communication usually takes place between three to twenty individuals.
- Mass communication – Mass communication is communication that employs some form of media like the television, radio, or the Internet to communicate with a very large audience.
- Effective organisational communication can enhance performance in the workplace.
- Communication contributes to success in the workplace as it provides:
 - Better employer-employee relationships
 - Problem- solving
 - Improved performance
 - Stronger link between managers and the external environment

8. GLOSSARY

Decoder	- A device or a person undoing the encoding to retrieve the original message
Encoder	- A device or a person which converts the message into some chunks of messages known only to it.
Linguistics	- The scientific study of the structure and semantics of a language.
Semantics	- The study of meanings, changes in meanings, and the principles that govern the relationship between sentences or words and their meanings

9. TERMINAL QUESTIONS

1. Explain briefly the characteristics of communication.
2. Describe a situation you experienced where communication was a failure. Analyse the problem by identifying the element of the communication process that contributed to the failure. For example, wrong sender, wrong channel, etc.
3. List out some barriers that stand in the way of your own communication.
4. How can an organisation overcome the barriers to communication?
5. Distinguish between interpersonal and intrapersonal communication.
6. What are the advantages of effective communication in an organisation?



10. ANSWERS

10.1. Self-Assessment Questions

1. Feedback
2. Sender
3. False. Each message is part of a process and does not occur in isolation.
4. True
5. False. A channel is a medium or the method used to deliver the message.
6. False. The given example is psychological noise.
7. True
8. a. Lack of interest
9. A – 3, B – 4, C – 1, D – 2
10. Linguistic barrier
11. Active listening
12. Feedback
13. False. Group communication usually takes place between three to twenty individuals.
14. True
15. Teamwork, Individual
16. Face-to-face
17. True

10.2. Terminal Questions Answers

1. The characteristics of communication are:
 - It is unavoidable
 - It is a two-way exchange of information
 - It is a process
 - It involves a sender and a receiver of information
 - It could be verbal or non-verbal
 - It is successful when the receiver interprets the meaning in the same way as that intended by the sender
- For more details, refer to section 2.

2. Communication may go wrong if any of the following key elements of communication such as sender or encoder, receiver or decoder, message, channel, feedback, noise, and context go wrong. For more details, refer to section 3.
3. There are several barriers to smooth communication. These may be classified as follows:
 - External or physical barriers
 - Individual barriers
 - Organisational barriers
 - Linguistic or cultural barriers
 - Semantic barriers
 - Channel barriers
 - Non-verbal barriersFor more details, refer to section 4.
4. Some of the measures that an organisation can take to overcome the barriers to communication are as follows:
 - Encourage feedback
 - Create a climate of openness
 - Use multiple channels of communication for more details, refer to section 4.
5. Interpersonal communication usually involves direct face-to-face contact between the sender and the receiver. Intrapersonal communication is self-communication. For more details, refer to section 5.
6. Effective communication in an organisation offers the following benefits:
 - Better employer-employee relationships
 - Problem- solving
 - Improved performance
 - Stronger link between managers and the external environment for more details, refer to section 6.

11. CASE STUDY

Nomura Group's Global

Communication Introduction

Nomura Group is one of the largest financial service organisations in Japan. It comprises a group of companies that includes Nomura Securities Co. Ltd, Nomura Asset Management Co. Ltd, and Joinvest Securities Co. Ltd. It also has overseas subsidiaries in the U.S, Europe and Asia.

Issue

Earlier, Nomura group used laptops as a main tool for communication. As the laptops were not easy to carry and they also required complicated configuration, Nomura was looking for a secure and convenient mobile solution that would free them from these stresses.

Nomura group required a global communication environment which allowed employees to access their enterprise network from anywhere in the world and work as if they were in an office.

Solution

In October 2006, Nomura Securities started investigating the usage of BlackBerry solution to solve their issues. In February 2007, it introduced about 50 BlackBerry smartphones, mainly in Nomura Securities Co., Ltd. In May 2007, it introduced the BlackBerry 8707h smartphone in full scale. The Information System departments at Nomura Holdings Inc. and Nomura Securities Co., Ltd. worked jointly to deploy and maintain the BlackBerry Enterprise Server, which controls the BlackBerry smartphones.

Reasons for selecting BlackBerry Solution

The convenience and high security of the solution made Nomura group opt for BlackBerry smartphones.

The overseas subsidiaries of the Nomura Group had already benefited from the usage of BlackBerry smartphones. The introduction of the BlackBerry solution facilitated daily communication in the business.

The BlackBerry solution is widely used in the financial world and the Nomura group appreciated the convenience and high security of the BlackBerry solution.

The key functions of BlackBerry that appealed to Nomura were message encryption and uniform device management. The BlackBerry Enterprise Server default functions allowed Nomura to adhere to the existing security policy.

Results

Nomura group enhanced their internal device management systems for introducing BlackBerry 8707h smartphone. It set up a user support desk and a network for wireless distribution of applications. It was able to distribute the Bloomberg application to convey important financial information to their securities business. Employees were able to get real-time news updates throughout the business day. The BlackBerry solution allowed employees to check emails, view attachments, and manage their schedule.

Discussion Questions:

1. What were the issues faced by the Nomura group in their business communication?
(Hint: Refer **Issues** section of the caselet)
2. Why did the Nomura group opt for a BlackBerry solution?
(Hint: Refer **Reasons for selecting BlackBerry Solution** section of the caselet)

(Source: http://us.BlackBerry.com/newsroom/success/Nomura_ENG_BCS.pdf)

12. REFERENCES

- Emmitt, S., & Gorse, C. (2003). *Construction Communication*. U.K.: Blackwell Publishing.
- Frey, L. R. (1999). *The Handbook of Group Communication Theory and Research*. U.S. A: Sage Publications.

Additional Reference:

- Jain, R. (2009). *Business Communication*. New Delhi: V.K.India Enterprises.

E-References:

- http://us.BlackBerry.com/newsroom/success/Nomura_ENG_BCS.pdf – Retrieved on November 21, 2011.
- <http://www.teleworkaustralia.net.au/doclibrary/public/Research/AJC ArticleMeyersHearnTelecommuting.pdf> – Retrieved on November 21, 2011.
- http://www.quintcareers.com/writing_skills_on_job.html – Retrieved on November 21, 2011.
- <http://faculty.buffalostate.edu/smithrd/UAE%20Communication/Unit4.pdf>– Retrieved on January 4, 2012.
- <http://www.effectivepresentationskills.com/infobank/communicationskills.html> – Retrieved on January 4, 2012.
- <http://faculty.buffalostate.edu/smithrd/UAE%20Communication/Unit7.pdf> – Retrieved on January 6, 2012.